

Forrest Lasiter

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT professional and U.S. Army veteran with 10+ years of experience supporting enterprise endpoints, networks, and control systems. Skilled in Active Directory, MECM/SCCM, Jamf, and Microsoft 365 across Windows, macOS, and Linux environments. Hands-on homelab practitioner operating a self-hosted virtualization environment with enterprise-style network segmentation, containerized services, and an isolated cybersecurity lab.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Systems & OS: Windows 10/11, macOS, Linux (Debian, Ubuntu), Active Directory, Group Policy (GPOs), MECM/SCCM, Jamf, Microsoft 365, Intune

Networking: TCP/IP, DHCP, DNS, VLANs, pfSense, WireGuard VPN, firewall rules, network segmentation, subnetting

Virtualization & Containers: Proxmox VE, QEMU/KVM, LXC, Docker, Docker Compose, k3s (Kubernetes), Portainer

Automation: Bash, PowerShell, systemd, udev, automated service deployment

Security: Network segmentation, least-privilege enforcement, isolated lab environments, patch management

WORK EXPERIENCE

Industrial Controls Technician | Whalen Automation and Integration 2024 – Present

- Engineer and maintain PLCs, HMIs, industrial robots, and automated control systems across active manufacturing environments.
- Diagnose faults in complex automation and electrical systems; identify root causes to minimize production downtime.
- Partner with engineering teams to design and integrate automation solutions into existing facility infrastructure.

PC Systems Analyst (Level II) | University of Arkansas – Fort Smith 2022 – 2024

- Managed endpoint lifecycle — imaging, deployment, and software distribution — for 500+ devices and 1,000+ users across a multi-building campus running Windows and macOS.
- Administered Active Directory, MECM/SCCM, and Jamf for endpoint management; maintained and supported campus-wide A/V systems.
- Resolved escalated Level II hardware and software issues; partnered with IT teams to refine support processes and reduce repeat ticket volume.

IT / Signal Support Specialist (25B/25U) | U.S. Army 2012 – 2019

- Maintained network infrastructure supporting 200+ users across forward-deployed environments in Kuwait and Iraq, ensuring reliable connectivity in high-tempo operations.
- Configured and maintained server stacks; performed computer patching, preventive maintenance, and network cabling under operational conditions.
- Supervised IT help desk operations in Kuwait; administered base surveillance systems and supported flight scheduling operations in Iraq.

HOMELAB INFRASTRUCTURE (SELF-DIRECTED)

Proxmox Virtualization Lab | Dell OptiPlex 7040 2026 – Present

- Designs and administers a self-hosted multi-VM environment (Proxmox VE) running concurrent workloads: containerized services via Docker and k3s, a pfSense firewall/router, and a dedicated Kali Linux cybersecurity lab.
- Implemented network segmentation using VLANs and isolated virtual bridges; pfSense enforces firewall rules between the home network and the isolated lab using DMZ-style segmentation.
- Configured least-privilege service execution, persistent USB device permissions via udev rules, and automated startup and recovery using systemd service units.

EDUCATION

University of Arkansas – Fort Smith Fort Smith, AR

B.S. – Electrical Engineering Technology May 2021

A.A.S. – Electronics Technology May 2019

MILITARY AWARDS & HONORS

Army Commendation Medal • Global War on Terrorism Service Medal • GWOT Expeditionary Medal • Operation Inherent Resolve Campaign Medal (2017) • Armed Forces Service Medal • Overseas Service Medal w/ Mobilization Device